Cassandra Williams

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AOS	Philosophy of Mind, Cognitive Science
AOC	Philosophy of Science, Philosophy of Biology, Philosophy of Artificial Intelligence, Philosophy of Action, Philosophy of Sexuality

Education

Ph.D., Philosophy (in progress)
University of Toronto — *2023 - Present*
Committee: Denis Walsh (Chair), Andrew Lee, Bill Seager, Evan Thompson

Ph.D. student in Philosophy
York University — *2022 - 2023*
(Transferred to University of Toronto September 2023)

M.A., History and Philosophy of Science and Technology
University of Toronto — *2021*

B.A., Philosophy and Cognitive Science
University of Toronto — *2019*

Conference Presentations

Refereed

1. "Would I Still Have Attention if I Was a Worm?" — *June 8, 2026*
   Canadian Philosophical Association, Dalhousie University
2. "Would I Still Have Attention if I Was a Worm?" — *June 6, 2026*
   Canadian Society for the History and Philosophy of Science, Dalhousie University
   Winner of 2026 Richard Hadden Award
3. "How Speculative is Biopsychism Really?" — *June 20, 2025*
   Society for Philosophy and Psychology, Cornell University
4. "How Speculative is Biopsychism Really?" — *June 12, 2025*
   The Edge of Sentience Workshop, Ruhr University Bochum
5. "Making Sense of Agency" — *July 24, 2024*
   International Conference for Artificial Life, IT University of Copenhagen
6. "Making Sense of Agency" — *June 21, 2024*
   Dimensions of Radical Embodiment, University of Murcia

7. "Making Sense of Agency" *May 6, 2024*
   On Purpose, Duke University
8. "Making Sense of Agency" *Mar 23, 2024*
   Southern Society for Philosophy and Psychology, Cincinnati, USA
9. "Radicalism Twice Over: Radical Structuralism, Radical Embodiment, and Subjectivity" *June 9, 2023*
   Berlin Workshop on Ecological Psychology, Technical University of Berlin
10. "Feeling It Out: Affectivity as Minimal Rationality" *Mar 18, 2023*
    Emotions, Reasons, and Rational Agency, University of Tennessee

Non-Refereed

11. "Would I still be sentient if I was a worm???" *Oct 20, 2025*
    Ontario Mind Group, Toronto, Canada

Commentaries

12. Comments on Tommaso Zorzini, "Reciprocal Causation in EES is Still Unidirectional" *May 27, 2026*
    Society for the Metaphysics of Science, University of Toronto
13. Comments on Thomas Morrison, "Deep Stability: The Explanatory Structures Account of Natural Kinds and Inductive Success" *May 25, 2026*
    Society for the Metaphysics of Science, University of Toronto
14. Comments on Fermin Fulda, "Life and the Dialectics of Matter and Form: Organicism between Dialectical Materialism and Hylomorphism" *Oct 12, 2025*
    Dialectical Biology Today: Legacies of Richard Lewontin, University of Toronto
15. Comments on Tanya Dushatska, "Artificial Intelligence, Phenomenal Consciousness, and Creative Agency" *June 20, 2025*
    Canadian Philosophical Association, George Brown College

Guest Lectures

16. "Investigating the Mind at its Lower Boundaries" *April 24, 2026*
    Cognitive Science and Theory of Communication, University of Messina

TEACHING

Primary Instructor

Philosophy of Human Sexuality *2026*
University of Toronto, Department of Philosophy

Freedom, Responsibility, and Human Action *2026*
University of Toronto, Department of Philosophy

Tutorial Leader

Persons, Minds and Bodies *2025*
University of Toronto, Department of Philosophy

Minds and Machines *2020, 2024, 2025*
University of Toronto, Department of Philosophy

Philosophy of Science *2024*
University of Toronto, Department of Philosophy

Introduction to Logic *2022*
York University, Department of Philosophy

The Limits of Machine Intelligence *2021*
University of Toronto, Institute for the History and Philosophy of Science and Technology

Introduction to Philosophical Problems *2018-9*
University of Toronto, Department of Philosophy

Fellowships, Grants, and Awards

Richard Hadden Award *2026*
Canadian Society for the History and Philosophy of Science

Graduate Student Service Award *2026*
Department of Philosophy, University of Toronto

Social Sciences and Humanities Research Council (SSHRC) Doctoral Fellowship *2024 – 2028*

Faculty of Arts & Science Top (FAST) Doctoral Fellowship *2023 – 2027*
University of Toronto

Vision: Science to Applications (VISTA) Doctoral Scholarship *2022 – 2023*
York University

Research Assistantships

Philosophy of Visual Perception *2022 – 2023*
Research Assistant to Jake Beck, York University

Graduate Coursework

(* = audited, † = in progress)

University of Toronto

Philosophy of Medicine *(Brian Baigrie)* * *Winter 2026*

Biological and Artificial Intelligence *(Jennifer Nagel)* * *Fall 2025*

Representational Content *(Imogen Dickie)* * *Fall 2025*

William James's Radical Empiricism *(Bill Seager)* *Winter 2024*

Aristotle's *De Anima* *(Jessica Gelber)* *Winter 2024*

Moral Obligations under Conditions of Injustice *(Sophia Moreau)* *Winter 2024*

The Structure of Consciousness *(Andrew Lee)* *Fall 2023*

Spinoza and Hume's Naturalisms *(Donald Ainslie, Michael Rosenthal)* *Fall 2023*

Philosophy of Clinical Epidemiology *(Brian Feldman, Brian Baigrie)* — *Fall 2023*

Advanced Intro to Philosophy of Science *(Mike Miller)* — *Fall 2023*

Consciousness, Qualia and Qualities *(Bill Seager)* — *Winter 2023*

Intro to the History and Philosophy of Science *(Brian Baigrie)* — *Fall 2021*

Metaphysics of Quantum Mechanics *(Mike Miller, Trevor Teitel)* — *Fall 2021*

Theories of Consciousness *(Bill Seager)* — *Fall 2021*

Teleology *(Denis Walsh, Marleen Rozemond)* — *Fall 2021*

History and Philosophy of the Social Sciences *(Mark Solovey)* — *Winter 2020*

Technology, Environment, and History *(Rebecca Woods)* — *Winter 2020*

York University

Stimulus, Context, and Control in Perception *(Kevin Lande)* * — *Winter 2023*

Perceptual Justification *(Jake Beck, Kevin Lande)* — *Fall 2022*

Rationality *(Kristin Andrews)* — *Fall 2022*

CUNY Graduate Center

Animal Consciousness and Society *(Kristin Andrews)* * — *Fall 2025*

SERVICE

Refereeing

Journals: *Philosophical Explorations*

Aristotle Contest — *2026*
Department of Philosophy
University of Toronto

Other Service

Climate Committee Member — *2025 – 2026*
Graduate Philosophy Students' Union
University of Toronto

Volunteer — *2025*
Dialectical Biology Today: Legacies of Richard Lewontin conference
University of Toronto

Graduate Student Peer Mentor — *2024 – 2026*
Department of Philosophy
University of Toronto

Volunteer — *2024*
Philosophy Graduate Student Conference
York University

Professional Experience

Research Engagement Coordinator *Jan 2026 – July 2026*
Schwartz Reisman Institute for Technology and Society
University of Toronto